

URGENT: Apple Rejection Fix — Resubmit ASAP

Status: PLEASE IMPLEMENT IMMEDIATELY

Context

Apple rejected Build 101 on August 5, 2026 with 3 issues. We are taking the fastest path to approval by removing all IAP/subscription references from v1.0. Subscriptions will be added in v1.1 after we're live.

Fix 1: Remove All In-App Purchase References (Code Change)

What to do: Remove or hide ALL references to subscriptions, premium tiers, upgrade prompts, paywall screens, and IAP product IDs from the app. The app should function as a fully free experience with no mention of paid features.

Specifically:

1. **Remove/hide any paywall or subscription screen** — If there's a screen that shows subscription options, pricing, or "Upgrade to Premium," remove it from navigation or conditionally hide it.
2. **Remove/hide any "Upgrade" buttons or CTAs** — Anywhere in the app that says "Upgrade," "Subscribe," "Go Premium," "Unlock," etc. — hide or remove.
3. **Remove StoreKit imports if unused elsewhere** — If StoreKit is only imported for IAP, remove the import. If it's used for other purposes (like App Store ratings), leave it.
4. **Remove/comment out IAP product ID constants** — Any hardcoded product IDs (like `com.mappingwithmelanin.premium.monthly`) should be removed or commented out.
5. **Remove any subscription-gated features** — If any feature checks for a subscription status before allowing access, remove that gate. All features should be accessible for v1.0.
6. **Do NOT remove the business dashboard analytics gate if it exists** — If analytics are gated behind a "Navigator" tier that's enforced server-side (not via IAP), that's fine to keep as long as there's no IAP purchase flow to unlock it. Just don't show a "Buy Navigator" button.

The rule: A user should be able to use the entire app without ever seeing the word "subscribe," "upgrade," "premium," or "purchase." There should be zero paths that lead to a StoreKit purchase sheet.

Fix 2: Update Age Rating in App Store Connect (Metadata — NOT code)

What to do: This is done by the Account Holder in App Store Connect, NOT in code.

1. Log into App Store Connect
2. Select the app (Mapping With Melanin)
3. Go to **App Information** (left sidebar)
4. Scroll to **Age Rating**
5. Find **"Parental Controls"** or **"In-App Controls"**
6. Change the selection to **"None"**
7. Save

Why: Apple says the app claims to have Parental Controls but they couldn't find them. Since we don't have parental controls, the metadata is wrong.

Fix 3: Remove IAP Products from the Submission (App Store Connect)

What to do: In App Store Connect:

1. Go to the app → **In-App Purchases** section
2. Any IAP products that are in "Ready to Submit" or "Waiting for Review" status — **remove them from this submission** or set them to "Developer Action Needed"
3. Do NOT delete them permanently — we'll use them in v1.1. Just don't include them in this submission.

Alternative: If you can't remove them from the submission, just make sure the app has zero references to them in code. Apple won't reject for having IAP products configured in Connect if the app itself never references them.

What NOT to Change

- Do NOT change any other app functionality

- Do NOT change the onboarding flow
 - Do NOT change the map, business listings, or Kinfolk
 - Do NOT change the waitlist flow
 - Do NOT add new features
 - Do NOT fix the font scaling issue yet (save for OTA after approval)
 - Do NOT implement Bug 1 or Bug 2 from the onboarding fix in this build — those go in the NEXT update after approval
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Build & Submit Checklist

- ☐ All IAP/subscription UI references removed or hidden
- ☐ No StoreKit purchase sheets can be triggered anywhere in the app
- ☐ No "Upgrade" or "Subscribe" buttons visible anywhere
- ☐ App functions fully as a free experience
- ☐ Age Rating updated to "None" for Parental Controls in App Store Connect
- ☐ IAP products removed from this submission (or left unconfigured)
- ☐ Increment build number (102)
- ☐ Test full app flow — ensure no dead-end screens where a paywall used to be
- ☐ Submit for review with a note to Apple:

Suggested App Review Note:

"We have removed all In-App Purchase references from this version. The app now functions as a fully free community platform. In-App Purchases will be introduced in a future update once properly configured and tested in sandbox. We have also corrected the Age Rating metadata to remove the Parental Controls reference."

Timeline

This should be a **same-day fix**. The changes are:

- Remove/hide IAP UI (1-2 hours max)
- Update App Store Connect metadata (5 minutes)
- Test full flow (30 minutes)
- Submit (5 minutes)

Apple typically reviews resubmissions within 24-48 hours. If submitted today (Aug 5), we could have approval by Aug 7-8 — well before the Aug 15 tour start.

Confirmation Required

After implementing, please confirm:

1. Screenshot showing no subscription/upgrade UI anywhere in the app
2. Build number incremented to 102
3. App Store Connect Age Rating shows "None" for Parental Controls
4. App Review note included with submission
5. Submission timestamp